

# VISION STATEMENT OF DR. ROGER D. POSADAS FOR THE PRESIDENCY OF THE UNIVERSITY OF THE PHILIPPINES (AUGUST- SEPTEMBER 2016)

## TRANSFORMING THE UNIVERSITY OF THE PHILIPPINES INTO A *TRULY GREAT NATIONAL UNIVERSITY*©

The University of the Philippines is a multi-campus state university system with a rich and glorious 108-year history that was founded on June 18, 1908 and officially declared the ***national university*** on April 29, 2008, by virtue of **Republic Act No. 9500**, “**An Act to Strengthen the University of the Philippines as the National University**”, which was signed into law by then President Gloria Macapagal Arroyo on April 29, 2008. And which mandated the University of the Philippines to (1) harness the expertise of the members of its community... to regularly study the state of the nation in relation to its quest for national development... formulate responsive policies and give advice to Congress and the President of the Philippines [Sec. 7], (2) *serve as a graduate university* by providing advanced studies...for scholars..., especially those who serve on faculty of state and private colleges and universities. [Sec. 3(b)], (3) *lead in setting academic standards and maintaining centers of excellence* [Sec.3 (a)], (4) *serve as a research university* [Sec.3(c)], (5) *lead as a public service university* [Sec.3(d)], (6) *serve as a regional and global university* [Sec. 3(g)] and (7) to commit itself to serve the Filipino nation and humanity [Sec. 8].

Unfortunately, since its enactment more than eight (8) years ago in April 2008, the lofty aspirations contemplated by R.A. 9500 for U.P. as the national university have not yet been fully realized.

Therefore, taking this shortcoming into consideration and taking off from the aspirations of R.A. 9500 for U.P. as the national university,

I would express my vision for the University of the Philippines as

***Transforming the University of the Philippines into a Truly Great National University*** and elaborate on this vision as follows©.

I envision U.P as a multi-campus non-sectarian *universitas* (community), primarily of teachers, scholars, and staff who will constitute an invaluable ***National Treasury of Intelligence Wisdom*** that will serve collectively, system-wide, as the premier ***Think Tank*** of the Philippine Government and the Filipino Nation even as it

will fulfill its social responsibility to the Filipino nation and to humanity by playing a reformist and righteous role as a social critic-gadfly-*Social Watchtower* on national and international issues instead of as a detached academic ivory tower. I also envisage U.P. as a whole, and each campus, eventually, to become a globally high-ranking globally competitive, and globally engaged *Global University* as well as a *Research University* with world-class research productivity in science and technology and renaissance-like creativity in arts and culture in which each campus will become a center of excellence in research and innovation as well as a hub for regional agro-industrial cluster development. I also envision U.P. to be the *Upholder of a well-balanced holistic education* embodying the fusion of competence-building and character development or expertise- *cum* nationalism and excellence- *cum*- ethics to develop outstanding and upstanding Filipino leaders. Furthermore, I envision U.P. as a whole and each campus to become the National Leader in the promotion and practice of “*aretocracy*”( i.e., the rule of excellence and meritocracy) -- and the rejection of “*mediocracy*” (i.e., the rule of mediocrity) and inbreeding plus cronyism– in academic management, particularly in hiring, and appointments, even as it will uphold the principles of academic freedom and responsibility, collegiality, and consultative democracy, transparency, accountability, shared cooperation, and stakeholder engagement in university governance. Moreover, U.P. in my vision, will also become an *Academic Innovator* that will offer pioneering, innovative, cutting-edge, and future-ready undergraduate and graduate programs in each campus (as appropriate), which will be responsive to, and aligned with, our country’s short-term and long-term national/regional human resource needs and problems and serve as the country’s or region’s *Graduate University* for the advanced studies of faculty members of state and private colleges and universities. I also envisage U.P to serve as the national *yardstick or benchmark* of excellence or quality in teaching and learning, democratic but meritocratic student admission, student rights and welfare, alumni relations, infrastructure, as well as campus development in terms of campus beauty, safety, and security among Philippine higher education institutions. Furthermore, I also envision U.P as a contributor to the creation of new businesses and jobs by becoming an *Entrepreneurial University* in which each campus will undertake the transfer and commercialization of university technologies and intellectual properties, develop both technology and social entrepreneurs and generate new technology startups, social innovations, and new jobs in each region of the campus (as appropriate). Finally, I envision U.P. to be a *Public Service University* that will practice and promote *Town-Gown Collaboration* and fulfill the university’s third mission of providing responsive, effective and sustained services to Philippine communities and industries in each campus’ region This vision of mine for the University of the Philippines can be succinctly summarized through the mnemonic acronym below ©:.

- T – *Treasury of intelligence and wisdom* that will serve collectively, system-wide, as the premier *Think Tank* of the Philippine Government and the Filipino Nation.**
- R – *Research University with world-class research productivity in science and technology* and *Renaissance-like creativity in arts and culture* in which each campus will develop into a regional center of excellence in research and innovation as well as a hub for regional agro-industrial cluster development.**
- U – *Upholder in each campus of a balanced holistic education* embodying competence-building and character development, expertise–*cum*- nationalism and excellence- *cum*- ethics to develop outstanding and upstanding Filipino leaders.**
- L – *Leadership* of the university system as a whole and of each campus in the promotion and practice of “*aretocracy*”( i.e., the rule of excellence and meritocracy) and the rejection of “*mediocracy*” (i.e., the rule of mediocrity) and inbreeding plus cronyism– in academic management, particularly in hiring, and appointments, even as it will uphold the principles of academic freedom and responsibility, collegiality, and consultative democracy, transparency, accountability, shared cooperation, and stakeholder engagement in university governance.**
- Y – *Yardstick or benchmark or national model of excellence or quality* in teaching and learning, student admission, student rights and welfare, alumni relations, infrastructure, as well as campus development in terms of campus beauty, safety, and security among Philippine higher education institutions**
- G – *Global University* in which the university system as a whole, and each campus, eventually, will become an internationally high- ranking, and internationally engaged global university.**
- R – *Reformist and Righteous Role* in Philippine society as a gadfly-social critic-***Social Watchtower*** instead of a detached academic ivory tower in each campus. .**
- E –*Entrepreneurial University* in which each campus will undertake the transfer and commercialization of university technologies and intellectual properties, develop both technology and social entrepreneurs and generate new technology startups, social innovations, and new jobs in each region of the campus (as appropriate).**
- A – *Academic Innovator* that will offer pioneering, innovative, cutting-edge, and future-ready undergraduate and graduate programs in each campus(as appropriate), which will be responsive to, and aligned with, our country’s short-term and long-term national/regional human resource needs and problems and serve as**

the country's or region's **Graduate University** for the advanced studies of faculty members of state and private colleges and universities. .

**I– Town-Gown Collaborator** in which each campus will serve as a **Public Service University** by fulfilling the university's *third mission* of providing appropriate systematic, sustained, and effective extension services in the region of the campus.

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